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r/GameAudio • 6y ago
imnickb

Looking for Sci-Fi Sound Design Techniques

I'm trying to make a concerted effort to really master sci-fi sound design. Does anyone have any suggestions where to look? Tutorials, books, blogs?

Edit: I'm mostly talking about weapons but interested in any thoughts you might have.

14 · 7

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The biggest thing for sci-fi sound design is making sure the sound design is grounded in realism. Yes, you're making a sci-fi gun, for example, but you need to understand how that gun operates. What are the physics behind it? Is it shooting a laser? Does it charge up first? Are any of the components of the gun physically moving?

You need to ask yourself, how is this futuristic object working and then how do all those individual components sound. Don't be afraid to use grounded objects as a base. Include a real gunshot in the mix, for example - just changed so that it's hardly recognizable. This will make the player feel that this is a real object, not just some synthesizers playing digital sounds.

Apply that technique to all aspects of your sound design.

14

proggybreaks • 6y ago

This is it- you start with something people recognize/expect and then "futurize" it.

1

[deleted] • 6y ago

That's a really big question. Sci-fi itself is extremely broad. My suggestion would be to just spend some time listening to sci-fi games and movies. Try to imitate some of the sounds your hear. Even more important, find some video clips that appeal to you and try doing some sound replacements.

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5

berto999 • 6y ago

William Whittingtons book on sound design in science fiction is an interesting read, it isn't really technical but good nonetheless

2

8ude • 6y ago

This is a great tutorial which covers a few techniques you can use.

https://m.youtube.com/watch?v=-_TGR2ux0nE

Like it says in the title - phone mic, at-hand sounds, stock plugins - that's all you need

Edit - Id also recommend mastering a soft synth - maybe make a bunch of sounds with Serum or a similar plugin. Could even be a stock synth in your DAW - I used Ableton's basic synths for years. Finding the right tone for your bleeps and bloops is an art.

2

ValourWinds • 6y ago

Great suggestions from folks all around. Having done my fair share of this work as well, I have a couple suggestions for where you might start.

Like others have suggested I would look closely at some examples of what you're after. You could take a look at the sounds of games like Doom Eternal, Outer Worlds, or Mass Effect.

Once youve heard some examples see if you can find articles on the design behind these games. There's a great resources on asoundeffect.com regarding this; maybe also look at the Jedi Fallen Order sound article and Borderlands 3, I think they're both quite extensively documented IIRC.

And then I would highly encourage messing around with synthesis and some good source libraries to start with. Barney Oram Low-Fi Sound Design is a good one in terms of commericial libraries, and then with synthesis if you have something like Massive or Absynth or Serum you can start with a fairly generic oscillating waveform of some kind and then just start creating "warble" textures as I like to call them.

These are actually tough to pull off but a pool of these to pull from is a really valuable thing, like textures of pitch rising and sound build up will help a lot with selling the sci fi nature of the weapons, this is the more nebulous part to design I find, more so than the ratchet and foley gears and mechanics often I find, esp. if we're talking weapons but the same principles can apply to doors.. forcefields, any other number of sci fi tropes.

Maybe consider investing in Boom Scifi Designed or Construction Kit and see how and what sources they are using to build some very stock and standard sci fi sounds, and just be creative with it. Record household foley and appliances and incorporate those into your sounds too. :)

1

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Need tips for dnb/neurofunk bass sound design

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Has sound design stagnated?

38 upvotes · 49 comments

r/serum • 2mo ago

Sound design tips

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r/MusicBattlestations • 27d ago

I think it pretty much looks like how the music I make sounds...



57 upvotes · 11 comments

r/okbuddyRunners • 5mo ago

on sound design:



206 upvotes · 24 comments

r/MusicProductionTuts • 6mo ago

What I've learned mixing over 100 tracks remotely

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r/dnbproduction • 7mo ago

Total beginner trying to make drum & bass — what should I focus on first?

8 upvotes · 11 comments

r/bilmuri • 4mo ago

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r/tranceproduction • 27d ago

How do producers make their trance leads sound so massive, epic, and larger than life? What kind of layering, reverb, and processing is involved?

15 upvotes · 17 comments

r/serum • 1mo ago

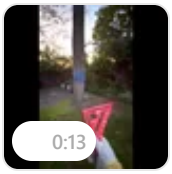
How do I create this phone sound on Serum? Or is there a preset for it?



100 upvotes · 31 comments

r/ScienceNcoolThings • 2mo ago

Scientifically speaking, how could I lower or raise the pitch of this cool sound?



33 upvotes · 9 comments

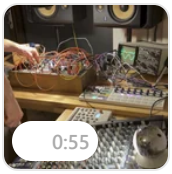
r/traveller • 5mo ago

Best Sci-fi music soundtracks that aren't dark / cheesy / world ending? Would love to choose a soundtrack from a movie or a video game and use only that music to have a vibe for my game that's starting soon :)

24 upvotes · 27 comments

r/modular • 4d ago

Love these sci fi Sounds, tell me your approaches on these kinds of sound. The crazier the better!



39 upvotes · 6 comments

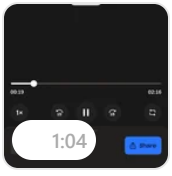
r/DungeonSynth • 17d ago

Is their such thing as Sci Fi synth or a genre like it?

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r/production • 7mo ago

Am I trying to mix too many genres?



93 upvotes · 176 comments

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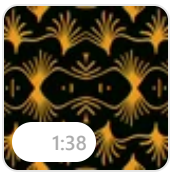
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Audio visualization



65 upvotes · 11 comments

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10 upvotes · 23 comments

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Where to start creating electronic music

8 upvotes · 6 comments

r/Cyberpunk_Music • 2mo ago

Looking for lonely, electronically atmospheric cyberpunk music with late 90s/early 2000s computer feeling

28 upvotes · 25 comments

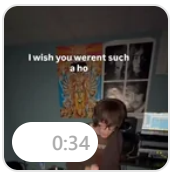
r/GameMusicComposition • 2mo ago

I want to make music for an indie game, where do I start?

7 upvotes · 29 comments

r/synthrecipes • 8d ago

what synth is this guy using / how can i recreate it



89 upvotes · 18 comments

r/soundfonts • 1mo ago

What are the best soundfonts?

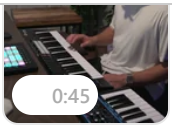
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r/DreamingFrench • 3mo ago

Best Audio-Only Beginner Resources?

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I love the fusion between nostalgic beats and modern electronic sound design. Anyone else exploring this?



48 upvotes · 14 comments

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